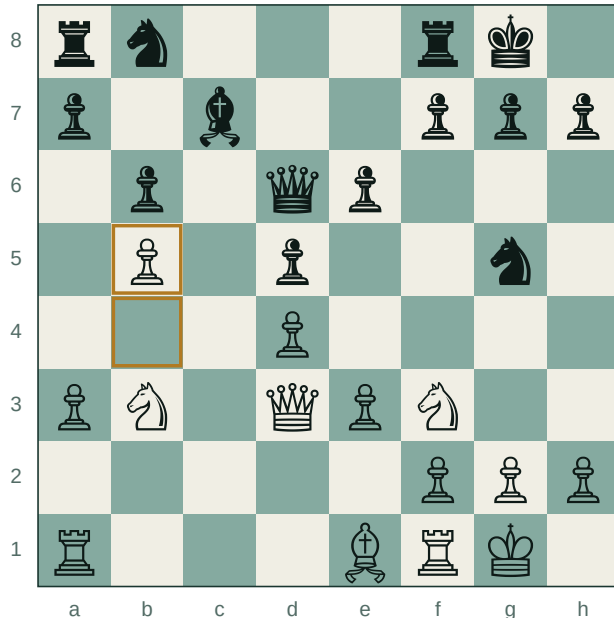


Kingside attacks: Black, move 17

Kingside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 17.b5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

17...Nxf3+ 18. gxf3 Qxh2#

17...Nxf3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From f3 it attacks king on g1 and bishop on e1. Recorded reply: **18.gxf3**.

18...Qxh2# Mate: queen on h2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on d3. Check for tactical protection.